Undercover

A lot of reptiles are very good at "camouflage" – the skill of blending into their natural surroundings. Camouflage is useful for avoiding enemies, as well as for sneaking up on prey without being seen.

Living logs

The swamps of Louisiana are full of alligators in disguise. Tiny algae (water plants) on the surface help to cover the gators so that they look like floating logs. They are actually hunting for their prey.



Alligators sometimes feed on prey as large as deer and cattle.

Coloring in

Cells in a chameleon's skin contain tiny grains of colored "pigments." Sometimes, the pigments move around inside the cells, or areas of pigment get bigger and smaller. This causes the skin to change in color.

A chameleon's skin color usually keeps it hidden against the natural background.

Snake in the grass

The patterns on a gaboon viper's skin help to disguise the outline of its body. This makes it difficult to spot when it is hiding among leaf litter in the forests of tropical Africa.